



However, despite everything the game still managed to do well commercially and sell almost as well as the first.

Devil May Cry 3: Dante's Awakening saw the return of Hideaki Itsuno, the same guy who directed DMC2. A great deal of attention was paid to the criticism DMC2 received. It looks like the developers wanted to do things right this time, and so they did. They worked on several of the issues that were raised by fans and critics regarding both the gameplay mechanics and the story. In response to this, DMC3's combat was made faster and tighter. It was more responsive and more punishing. DMC2's weak plot was addressed as well, DMC3 was created as a prequel to the first DMC and featured a younger Dante. It explored his relationship with his twin brother Vergil. A special edition of DMC3 was later released where players could play as Vergil once they beat the game. DMC3 revived the franchise and was released to critical acclaim. It made several improvements to the original game and was deemed a worthy successor by fans and critics alike.

Come 2008, we see the release of Devil May Cry 4. DMC4 is the first title in the franchise to make the generation leap. It was released for the PlayStation 3 and the Xbox 360, with a PC release later the same year. We're introduced to a new protagonist, Nero, who the players control for around half of the game. However, Dante does appear, first as an enemy and then as a player character for the latter half of

Titles

As we just mentioned, DMC was originally intended to be a Resident Evil title. It's not that surprising considering they're both Capcom titles. Those of you who've played both DMC and Resident Evil would've noticed some similarities between the two. Things like the warning screen at the start of the game, and the "You Are Dead" game over screen are almost identical. Even the trademark fixed camera angle is something both these titles share. However, that's where the similarities ended. After much development the creators realised that the game had drifted too far from the Resident Evil formula to be called a Resident Evil game. But they had invested a lot of time and work on this, so rather than completely scrapping it, then development Director Hideki Kamiya handed the project over to Shinji Mikami – Creator of the original Resident Evil – and continued development under a different name. The result was Devil May Cry. DMC was both critically praised and commercially success-

ful which was no easy feat for a new and unknown franchise.

After seeing DMC's success, Capcom obviously wanted to capitalize on this. When DMC2 was released after just about a year or so, it was more than obvious that it was rushed. It wasn't received too well by critics or fans alike who gave it poor reviews and called it a cash grab attempt by Capcom, which in all honesty, it was. Capcom simply took a game which was still in development under another Director – Hideaki Itsuno – and overhauled it into a DMC Sequel. What we got was a rushed release that failed to deliver and stand up to the original.

